Use ChatGPT to Sort Out What You Know Before You Ask Whether Medicaid Can Help

Four prompts to write down what you've been told, separate what you know from what you're guessing, note what may need a closer look, and prepare your questions for a professional.

Where you are

Mom needs care now and the family is paying for it. Someone said she has too much money for Medicaid. Someone else said to "spend down." Nobody has explained what either one means for her.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not determine eligibility, give legal or financial advice, or decide. Medicaid rules vary by state. Bring eligibility questions to your Medicaid planner and legal questions to an elder law attorney.

What you'll have at the end

You can say what you know about Mom's situation, what you've only been told, and which questions a professional still has to answer.

A one-page list: What we know, What we don't know, Questions we need answered, and who to ask.

Before you start

- Whatever you've been told about Medicaid so far, and who said it.
- A rough list of Mom's income, accounts, and property. Estimates are fine; leave account numbers out.
- Anything you remember about gifts, transfers, or changes in ownership. You don't need everything.

PROMPT 1

Write down what you've been told

WHY THIS MATTERS

By now you've probably heard several things about Medicaid: from the facility, a friend, a relative, the internet. Some of it may fit Mom's state and situation and some may not. Before you act on any of it, get it on paper with a name next to it.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything you've been told about Medicaid and Mom, in your own words, and who said each thing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what our family has been told so far about Medicaid and my mother's situation, and who told us:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Using only what I've written, make a table with three columns: WHAT WE WERE TOLD, WHO SAID IT, and WHAT WE WOULD NEED TO CONFIRM. Do not tell me whether any statement is correct, and do not add Medicaid rules, limits, or dollar figures of your own. The rules vary by state, and I will confirm them with a professional.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A list of the things you've heard, each with its source, and none of them treated as settled.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Mark the two statements your family has been leaning on most. Those go to the top of your question list.

PROMPT 2

Separate what you know from what you're guessing

WHY THIS MATTERS

"She has too much money" is a conclusion. What Mom receives each month and what she owns are facts, and many families are working from memory. A professional can only work from the facts.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your rough list of Mom's income, accounts, property, and insurance, and whether she has a spouse living at home.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I know about my mother's income, accounts, property, insurance, and household:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES, WITHOUT ACCOUNT NUMBERS]
>
> Sort each item into one of three lists: SEEN ON PAPER (I have a statement or document), REMEMBERED OR TOLD (no document yet), and DON'T KNOW. Use only what I wrote. Do not add up totals, do not label anything as countable or exempt, and do not compare anything with a Medicaid limit. Then list the documents I would need to find to move items onto the first list.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How much of your picture rests on paper and how much on memory.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Start looking for the documents on the list. Decisions about spending or moving anything belong in a conversation with a professional.

PROMPT 3

Note what may need a closer look

WHY THIS MATTERS

Gifts, transfers, and changes in who owns what can matter when someone applies for Medicaid, and how they are treated depends on the state and the details. You don’t need to judge them. You need them written down so the right person can.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Anything you remember about gifts, money or property that changed hands, names added to accounts or deeds, trusts, annuities, or life insurance.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what our family remembers about gifts, transfers, changes in ownership, trusts, annuities, and life insurance involving my mother:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> List each item with what happened, roughly when, who was involved, and what paperwork we have. Mark anything where the date or the details are unclear. Do not tell me whether any item is a problem, do not mention any look-back period or penalty, and do not suggest what to do about it. End with the questions I should ask the relatives who might remember more.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A plain record of what happened and when, with the unclear spots marked.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the relatives who might remember. Add what they say, with their name beside it.

PROMPT 4

Sort your questions by who can answer them

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some gaps you can close by finding a statement. Others belong to a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, or the facility's business office. Knowing which is which is the whole point of this guide.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've gathered about my mother's situation:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Give me one page with three headings: WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE DON'T KNOW, and QUESTIONS WE NEED ANSWERED. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: family (by finding a document), a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, the facility's business office, or not sure. Do not answer the eligibility questions, estimate whether she qualifies, or suggest any legal or financial step.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could hand to a professional and have them see where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've organized what you know and what you don't. The planning interview walks you through your family's situation one question at a time, so nothing important is left out, and turns your answers into a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›